

# 3-Month JavaScript + React Interview Mastery Plan

*Built around 'Chai aur JS' & 'Chai aur React' — 8 focused hours a day*

This is a 12-week, day-by-day routine to take you from watching tutorials to walking into interviews with confidence. It is built for 8 hours/day, split between watching, hands-on coding, revision, and interview-specific practice — because watching alone does not get you hired, building and recalling does.

## The Golden Rules

### 1. The 20/80 rule

Never spend more than 20% of a day just watching videos. The other 80% must be typing code yourself, without pausing to copy. Watch once, then close the video and rebuild it from memory.

### 2. One topic, three touches

Watch it → build a mini demo → explain it out loud (or write a short note) as if teaching a junior dev. If you can't explain it simply, you don't know it yet.

### 3. No tutorial hopping

Stick to Chai aur JS and Chai aur React end-to-end. Switching resources mid-way kills momentum and creates knowledge gaps. Use outside resources only to clarify a stuck concept.

### 4. Build 1 real project every 2 weeks

Interviewers care about projects and your ability to talk about decisions you made, not how many videos you watched.

### 5. Daily recall, weekly revision, monthly mock interview

Spaced repetition is what moves things from short-term to long-term memory. Follow the review cadence in this plan strictly.

### 6. Keep a public GitHub + a notes vault

Commit code daily. Keep short markdown notes per topic (in Notion/Obsidian/plain .md files) — this becomes your revision material in month 3.

### 7. Protect 1 full rest half-day per week

8 hours a day for 3 months is a marathon. Burnout will cost you more days than rest will. Take Sunday afternoon off.

## Your Daily 8-Hour Split (use this every single day)

| Block | Duration | What you do |
|-------|----------|-------------|
|-------|----------|-------------|

|                           |         |                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Watch & take notes     | 2 hrs   | Watch Chai aur JS / Chai aur React at 1x–1.25x. Pause and write short notes in your own words. No coding yet — just understand the 'why'.                         |
| 2. Rebuild from scratch   | 3 hrs   | Close the video. Re-type every example yourself in your own editor without looking, referring back only when stuck. This is where real learning happens.          |
| 3. Apply / build feature  | 1.5 hrs | Use today's concept inside your ongoing project (see project list below), or solve 2–3 small coding challenges based on it.                                       |
| 4. Interview-style recall | 1 hr    | Answer 3–5 interview questions on today's topic out loud / in writing, no notes. Cover JS output-based questions, React 'why does this re-render' questions, etc. |
| 5. Log & plan tomorrow    | 0.5 hr  | Commit code to GitHub, update your notes vault, write 2 lines on what felt shaky today so you revisit it in the weekend review.                                   |

*Tip: Blocks 1–2 total 5 hours of 'learning', but only 2 of those are passive watching. The remaining 3 hours of the day are 100% active — that ratio is what separates people who 'finished the course' from people who can code in a live interview.*

## Month 1 (Weeks 1–4): JavaScript Foundations → Advanced

Goal: finish Chai aur JS completely and be able to solve JS output-based & logic-based interview questions without hesitation.

| Week | Focus                                                                                                                                           | Deliverable                                                        |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | JS basics: variables, data types, operators, conditionals, loops, functions, scope, hoisting, execution context.                                | 30 output-based JS questions solved & explained in notes.          |
| 2    | Arrays & objects deep dive, higher-order functions (map/filter/reduce), closures, callbacks, 'this' keyword.                                    | Mini project: a to-do list or expense tracker using pure JS + DOM. |
| 3    | Asynchronous JS: callbacks, promises, async/await, event loop, microtask vs macrotask queue, fetch API / AJAX.                                  | Build a weather app or GitHub-user-search app using a public API.  |
| 4    | ES6+ features (destructuring, spread/rest, modules, classes, prototypes, prototypal inheritance), DOM manipulation & events, debounce/throttle. | Full revision + 1 timed mock JS round (45 min, no notes).          |

## Month 2 (Weeks 5–8): React Foundations → Advanced Patterns

Goal: finish Chai aur React and be able to build & explain a full React app: components, state, hooks, routing, and API integration.

| Week | Focus                                                                                                                                           | Deliverable                                                                               |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5    | React basics: JSX, components, props, state, useState, conditional rendering, lists & keys, event handling, forms.                              | Rebuild 2 course projects fully from memory, no copy-pasting.                             |
| 6    | Hooks deep dive: useEffect, useRef, useMemo, useCallback, custom hooks, component lifecycle, controlled vs uncontrolled inputs.                 | Build a currency converter or password generator app with custom hooks.                   |
| 7    | State management: Context API, prop drilling problem, intro to Redux Toolkit, React Router (nested routes, dynamic routes, protected routes).   | Build a multi-page app (e.g., notes app or e-commerce cart) with routing + context/Redux. |
| 8    | Performance & real-world patterns: React.memo, lazy loading & Suspense, error boundaries, connecting to a backend/API, basic testing awareness. | Full revision + 1 timed mock React round (live-code a small component, 45 min).           |

## Month 3 (Weeks 9–12): Projects, DSA-lite, Mock Interviews

Goal: stop learning new syntax. Convert everything into interview-ready projects, sharp recall, and real interview reps.

| Week | Focus                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Deliverable                                                              |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 9    | Build Capstone Project #1: a full-stack-feeling React app (auth flow UI, API calls, routing, global state) — polish UI, write clean commits.                                                          | Deployed project #1 (Vercel/Netlify) + README explaining architecture.   |
| 10   | Build Capstone Project #2 (different domain — e.g., dashboard with charts, or a clone of a real product). Start daily light DSA (arrays/strings/objects) since many interviews mix JS logic with DSA. | Deployed project #2 + 20 easy DSA problems solved in JS.                 |
| 11   | Interview-specific prep: JS 'gotcha' output questions, React theory Q&A; (virtual DOM, reconciliation, keys, re-render triggers), system-design-lite for frontend, resume + portfolio polish.         | A personal Q&A; cheat-sheet (50+ Q&A;) + polished resume/portfolio site. |
| 12   | Full mock interview week: 1 mock interview every alternate day (peer, mentor, or AI-based), rapid revision of weak spots logged through the 12 weeks, rest well before real interviews.               | Minimum 4 mock interviews completed + weak-topics list closed to zero.   |

## Weekly Rhythm (repeat every week)

- Mon–Fri: Follow the daily 8-hour split above on new topics.
- Saturday: No new topics. Spend the day extending your project with what you learned that week (build, don't watch).
- Sunday morning: Revise the week — redo your toughest 5 notes/questions from memory, fix your weakest area.
- Sunday afternoon: Rest. Fully off. This is what makes 8 hrs/day sustainable for 12 weeks.

## Interview-Readiness Checklist (before month 3 ends)

- Can explain closures, hoisting, event loop, and 'this' with a live code example, no notes.
- Can explain the difference between var/let/const, == vs ===, and shallow vs deep copy.
- Can explain useEffect dependency array behavior and common bugs it causes.
- Can explain virtual DOM, reconciliation, and why keys matter in lists.
- Has 2+ deployed projects with clean GitHub READMEs and can talk through architecture decisions.
- Can solve a medium JS logic problem (array/string manipulation) in under 20 minutes, talking out loud.
- Has done at least 4 mock interviews and stopped repeating the same mistakes.
- Resume is 1 page, project-focused, with metrics/impact where possible.

## A Few More Tips That Actually Move the Needle

- **Don't binge-watch multiple hours straight.**

Split the 2 'watch' hours into two 1-hour sessions if focus drops — retention falls sharply past 45–50 minutes of continuous video.

- **Write, don't just read, the interview answers.**

Typing/speaking an answer out loud exposes gaps that silent reading hides.

- **Use the 'explain to a rubber duck' method.**

If you can't explain `useEffect` or closures simply in 60 seconds, you're not ready — go back and rebuild the demo.

- **Track a 'confusion log'.**

Every time something doesn't click, write it down instantly. Revisit this log every Sunday — this becomes your highest-leverage revision material.

- **Apply for interviews starting week 9, not just week 12.**

Real interviews (even ones you're not fully ready for) are the fastest feedback loop — they show you exactly what to fix.

---

*Stick to this consistently for 12 weeks, and by the end you won't just have 'watched' Chai aur JS and Chai aur React — you'll have shipped projects, built recall under pressure, and rehearsed the interview itself. That's what gets offers.*